

WEEK 2 – PRODUCT AND USER JOURNEY

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I. Product description

We are building a B2B SaaS platform, **Sero**, for intelligent biology-centric digital focus management, designed to help enterprises and knowledge workers reclaim time and optimize their energy cycles in order to achieve **max flow** (pardon the algorithms pun). The goal is to utilise the nascent field of computer use agents and [always-on RL](#) (a la Cursor, but for actions instead of tab autocomplete in IDEs) to dynamically learn from user habits, task patterns, and circadian rhythms, thereby optimising a standard office worker's productivity. Sero combines biological awareness, autonomous reinforcement learning, and privacy-first analytics to maximise flow without eroding trust.

- **Autonomous focus support:** Our reinforcement learning engine continuously observes user actions and predicts whether a task, app, or site is likely to deliver value in the moment. Based on that, it delivers either a gentle nudge (*soft bump*) or a stronger redirection (*hard bump*) to keep focus aligned with personal goals.
- **Biology-aware productivity:** Most workplaces still measure productivity by time: a Taylorist relic that fuels workaholism and ignores natural energy cycles. By aligning with each user's circadian rhythm, Sero helps knowledge workers tap into their deep and shallow-work windows, sustain focus, and unlock more hours for meaningful work and personal life.
- **Privacy-preserving insights:** Using differential privacy, Sero aggregates data across the workforce to show managers what drives focus and well-being, without ever exposing individual data. This way, teams feel supported, not monitored, while enterprises gain actionable intelligence to create healthier, more productive work cultures.
- **Future-proof AI integration:** As computer use agents and action-first copilots begin to shape how digital work gets done, they will need reliable signals about user context, intent, and focus in order to act effectively. Sero provides this missing layer, continuously learning from user habits and rhythms to generate high-quality behavioural data and intelligent guidance. This creates both defensibility and long-term strategic value.

II. Competitor analysis

	Opal	Insightful	Timeular	Sero (us)
Description	A digital well-being/focus app. Blocks distracting apps/sites, schedules “focus sessions,” gives “Focus Score”, and reports.	Employee monitoring + productivity tracking + time & attendance, app/web usage, workflows, etc. Geared toward teams/enterprises.	Time tracking tool (tracking time spent, billing, integrations with calendar/tools, etc.). Less about blocking; more about measuring where time goes.	Monitors screen activity, blocks/redirects distractions during set hours; enterprise dashboards; data can feed copilots/agents.
USP	Great UX for individuals, gamification, and a strong privacy stance.	Enterprise-ready dashboards, process optimisation, and on-premise options.	Excellent for billable hours; sleek time-mapping UX; good integrations.	Designed enterprise-first; potential to monetise aggregated, anonymised behaviour datasets.
Pricing	Free plan; Pro ~\$8.29/month billed annually; lifetime option ~\$399	From ~\$6.40/user/month (annual). Higher tiers ~\$12+/user/month	Multiple tiers (Personal, Pro, Team, Enterprise); from ~\$7–\$10/user/month	Personal: free forever Pro (agentic features, biology-aware/smart device integrations, etc.): \$15.99 per month Enterprise: \$34.99 per month per seat
Limitation	Consumer-focused, weak on enterprise features, limited enforcement, and no aggregated data sharing.	Seen as surveillance, weak on distraction blocking/redirecting; can face user resistance.	Not for blocking; reactive only; weak on behaviour change or enforcement.	Still early-stage; must overcome OS restrictions, ensure privacy compliance.

Why the idea doesn't exist yet: Most apps today either block distractions for individuals (like Opal) or track work for managers (like DeskTime, Insightful). None combines dopamine-aware tracking, real-time redirection, and enterprise rollout. And no existing software is designed to be computer-use agent aware, built to plug into the new wave of copilots and action agents. Because AI in the workplace is only just emerging (and in particular, computer use agents are an extremely nascent technology that has come about only in the last <1 year), the tools that feed and guide these agents simply haven't been built yet. That's where Sero comes in: it bridges personal focus tools and corporate productivity platforms in a way that hasn't been done yet.

Pricing justification calculation:

Assume the average worker loses about 10 of their "productive hours" per week of the 40 or 50 that they work. At a mid-sized company with around 150-200 employees, that's up to 2000 hours a week of productivity lost to low-output tasks and distraction. According to the BLS Employer Costs for Employee Compensation (ECEC), the average amount of value given per hour is somewhere between \$50 and \$70 per hour, with some fields going up to \$80, suggesting nearly \$160K in losses every single week. Across roughly 50 work weeks, that's more than \$8M in value lost purely because of technological distraction and biological desynchronisation.

Now, in terms of the cost savings, we can assume that the product will cut distraction by 20% on baseline (in theory, it should be able to cut distraction by as much as 80-90% once the algorithm hits on the user's biological cycle and verifies it with data, but as a baseline, we'll use 20%). When increasing 200 employees' "productive hours" by 2 hours each week, that's another 400 hours aka \$32K savings per week. At the unit economics level as well, 2 hours per week can go up to more than \$150 total or roughly \$600 monthly, which is more than 17x the \$34.99 per seat per month price tag.

III. Stakeholder analysis

Customer (managers/higher-ups):

- Values and Motivations: Want higher productivity, fewer distractions, healthier employee focus, and data that can inform management decisions.
- Expected Behaviours: Evaluate Sero vs alternatives, pilot with small teams, then roll out across departments if it proves effective. Careful about privacy optics and employee acceptance.

User (the individual knowledge worker):

- Values and Motivations: Want help staying focused without feeling spied on. Value autonomy, well-being, and transparency. Will accept Sero if it feels supportive, not punitive. Will also have privacy-related concerns.
- Expected Behaviours: Some will embrace it as a productivity aid, others may resist if it feels like surveillance. Likely to engage more if they see personal benefits (e.g., focus insights, gentle redirection).

Regulator (Data protection authorities, and workplace compliance regulators):

- Values & Motivations: Ensure that Sero's data collection and usage respects privacy, transparency, and worker rights.
- Expected Behaviours: May audit or set rules for what Sero can track/store. Will be critical of the differential privacy metrics implemented. Would ensure that employee data is not used to train AI models

Investors (VCs, angels, or strategic investors):

- Values & Motivations: Want scalable SaaS growth, a clear path to enterprise adoption, and a future data/AI moat. Interested in differentiation from existing tools.
- Expected Behaviors: Push for growth metrics, clear positioning in the “future of work” + “AI agents” space, and clarity on privacy/compliance risks

Owners (Founders, aka us):

- Values & Motivations: Building Sero into a category-defining tool, balancing mission (better digital focus) with profit.
- Expected Behaviours: Set vision and strategy, raise capital, decide on product direction.

Employee (Sero team):

- Values & Motivations: Want to work on a meaningful, impactful product in the productivity/AI space. Value clarity, mission, and good internal culture.
- Expected Behaviours: The Early team will be motivated by mission and equity. As the company scales, expect demands for stability, career growth, and alignment with ethical use of data.

Productivity psychology science/researchers:

- Values & Motivations: Seek out arenas within which to test their research and observe large-scale impacts of circadian rhythms, biology-focussed productivity, etc.
- Expected Behaviours: We're hoping to be able to work with a number of high-profile and well-established psychologists and productivity researchers (e.g. Anne Laure Le-Cunff,

Oliver Burkeman, Ali Abdaal, etc.) in order to both publicise their research through our app and also demonstrate the utility (or potential change in hypotheses) of their experiments.

Technological researchers:

- Values & Motivations: Require significant testing environments and large-scale data pools in order to improve performance across the tool calling and computer use domains.
- Expected Behaviours: Hopefully, we'll be able to partner with design partners and AI labs/data companies and provide them with consensually obtained data in order to improve the models. There is also a potential to improve the models/obtain white-labelled or custom models later down the line.

IV. User journeys

“User” journey (an individual knowledge worker employee):

An employee will first begin by signing in through e.g. company SSO and initiating the installation. They will be asked to consent to a clear and minimal data-usage policy: what kinds of behavior are tracked, how overrides work, and how privacy is protected. They then set up their work routine—defining core focus windows (for example 8-12 AM), linking task sources (calendar, calendar tasks, to-do apps), answering a short survey about their sleep/wake times, perceived high-energy periods, and preferences for interruptions. This seeds the system's understanding of their circadian rhythm and productivity habits.

Over the first week (a calibration period), the agent quietly monitors usage: what apps get used, which sites are visited, how often tasks are switched, when attention drifts. It begins classifying “low-return” versus “high-value” activities. Meanwhile, the system starts sending gentle nudges when it detects drift—e.g. “Looks like you switched from email to social media—want to return to your top-priority task?”, or soft redirections rather than hard blocks. Once calibrated, during each user's declared focus windows the system applies adaptive guardrails: temporarily muting notifications, hiding or blocking pre-agreed distracting sites or apps, but offering override options where needed, labeling the reason so the system learns. Outside of focus windows, less restrictive settings apply, allowing freer access but still with feedback and suggestions when usage is particularly wasteful. At day's end or week's end, the user sees a private report: how many hours reclaimed (vs baseline), what were top distractors, how often they overrode blocks, and suggestions: maybe shift focus windows slightly, adjust break periods, or change timing of certain tasks to better align with their high-energy hours.

Note that throughout the whole process, control remains with the user: they can disable guardrails, adjust focus windows, or export/delete personal data. Privacy is emphasized.

Executive “Customer” Journey (buyer/admin—prioritize this path):

The executive starts by recognizing the cost: if each of ~200 knowledge workers loses ~10 productive hours/week, that’s ~2,000 man-hours per week wasted. Using the most recent U.S. BLS data, employer cost for compensation (wages + benefits) in private industry is \$45.38/hr.

Multiplying: 2,000 hours × \$45.38/hr = \$90,760/week in lost value. Over ~50 workweeks/year, that’s about \$4.5 million/year lost purely due to distraction, context switches, calendar inefficiencies, and circadian misalignment. The executive evaluates the tool as a way to recover a percentage of that loss—say a baseline 20% recovery. With 20% regained, that yields ~400 productive hours/week saved, or ~\$18,000/week (~\$900,000/year), which easily pays for a reasonable price per seat.

From the procurement side, the customer team then engages in an evaluation of factors including but not limited to:

- Security/compliance (SSO, data retention, privacy controls)
- Potential target teams to pilot the tool with + setting up target metrics for each of these teams
- Creating and reviewing dashboards and aggregate metrics, ensuring that usage is increasing focus time, lowering low-return tasks, and aligning with energy cycles of staff
- Identifying a path to eventually scaling to the full org

Within the process, the executive should see significant ROI in saved man-hours * cost per hour minus spend on subscription. They monitor via weekly / monthly reports: “hours reclaimed × loaded hourly cost – subscription cost = net gain.” They use that to justify renewals, seat expansion, or integration with other productivity / copilot tools.